

| Assessment | Test                | Domain                       | Skill                      | Difficulty                                          |
|------------|---------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| SAT        | Reading and Writing | Standard English Conventions | Form, Structure, and Sense | Medium <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |

Question

The Proto-Nilotic language, common ancestor of fifty-five African languages with similar linguistic properties, \_\_\_\_\_ like all protolanguages, hypothetical: there’s no direct evidence these ancestral languages actually existed.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Answer

- A. is,
- B. are,
- C. have been,
- D. were,

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "is" agrees in number with the singular subject "the Proto-Nilotic language." Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb "are" doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject "the Proto-Nilotic language." Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb "have been" doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject "the Proto-Nilotic language." Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb "were" doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject "the Proto-Nilotic language."